

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 2, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 107:23-43

23 Those who go down to the sea in ships, Who do business on great waters,

24 They see the works of the Lord, And His wonders in the deep.

25 For He commands and raises the stormy wind, Which lifts up the waves of the sea.

26 They mount up to the heavens, They go down again to the depths; Their soul melts because of trouble.

27 They reel to and fro, and stagger like a drunken man, And are at their wits' end.

28 Then they cry out to the Lord in their trouble, And He brings them out of their distresses.

29 He calms the storm, So that its waves are still.

30 Then they are glad because they are quiet; So He guides them to their desired haven.

31 Oh, that men would give thanks to the Lord for His goodness, And for His wonderful works to the children of men!

32 Let them exalt Him also in the assembly of the people, And praise Him in the company of the elders.

33 He turns rivers into a wilderness, And the watersprings into dry ground;

34 A fruitful land into barrenness, For the wickedness of those who dwell in it.

35 He turns a wilderness into pools of water, And dry land into watersprings.

36 There He makes the hungry dwell, That they may establish a city for a dwelling place,

37 And sow fields and plant vineyards, That they may yield a fruitful harvest.

38 He also blesses them, and they multiply greatly; And He does not let their cattle decrease.

39 When they are diminished and brought low Through oppression, affliction, and sorrow,

40 He pours contempt on princes, And causes them to wander in the wilderness where there is no way;

41 Yet He sets the poor on high, far from affliction, And makes their families like a flock.

42 The righteous see it and rejoice, And all iniquity stops its mouth.

43 Whoever is wise will observe these things, And they will understand the lovingkindness of the Lord.

II. Key Summary

- Verses 23–32 describe sailors who, caught in a violent storm at sea and utterly helpless, cry out to the Lord — and He calms the storm and guides them to their desired haven
 - Verses 33–42 show God's authority to transform both land and human circumstances: turning fruitful land into barrenness (judgment), desert into watersprings (blessing), humbling princes, and lifting the poor on high
 - The psalm closes in verse 43 with a wisdom saying: "Whoever is wise will observe these things, and they will understand the lovingkindness of the Lord"
-

III. Passage Analysis

Out at Sea Is Where You See the Wonders of the Deep

"When people pursue worldly gain, God allows them to pass through violent winds and waves. Only when 'all their wisdom is swallowed up' do they cry out to God and submit to His powerful rescue." [1]

Verse 24 says those who sail see "the works of the Lord, and His wonders in the deep" — not from the safety of the shore, but right in the middle of the storm. Every person's situation is different, but what never changes is where God guides them in the end: their desired haven.

Wisdom Is Learning to See What God Is Doing

"It is himself that the reader is to recognize in the fourfold picture of plight and

salvation, and it is the steadfastness of God that he is now to praise with new insight."
[2]

Psalm 107 ends with a wisdom statement: observe these things, and you will understand the lovingkindness of the Lord. To observe isn't passive — it means actively paying attention to where God is at work: in storms, in desert land turned to watersprings, in the moment someone overlooked gets lifted up. That kind of attentiveness is what builds a real understanding of who God is.

IV. Reflection Question

What do you think makes someone truly wise — what sets them apart from everyone else?

Psalm 107 says wisdom is "observing these things" — paying attention to how God moves through the storms and reversals of life — and from that, understanding His lovingkindness.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study, A Comprehensive Reading of the Bible,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.net/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT107.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik (quoting Derek Kidner),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-107/>